“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Antya-līlā

Chapter 12

Śrī Caitanya’s Dealings with Jagadānanda Paṇḍita

(translated from the Bengali for this edition)

1 O devotees, hear, hear constantly the nectar of Śrī Caitanya’s deeds; sing, sing it with joy; meditate, meditate on it.

2 Glory, glory to Śrī Caitanya! Glory to the merciful Lord! Glory, glory to Nityānanda! Glory to the ocean of mercy!

3 Glory to Advaitacandra, the ocean of compassion! Glory to the devotees of Gaura, whose hearts are full of mercy!

4 After this Mahāprabhu’s heart was dejected, and His state of separation from Kṛṣṇa manifested in Him constantly.

5 “Alas, alas, Kṛṣṇa, Lord of My life, son of the king of Vraja! Where shall I go? Where shall I find You, O You whose lips hold the flute?”

6 Night and day He was in this state, and there was no peace in His mind. With difficulty He passed the nights in the company of Svarūpa and Rāmānanda.

7 Meanwhile in the land of Gauḍa all the Lord’s devotees set out to see Him.

8 Śivānanda Sena, Advaita Ācārya and all the devotees gathered in one place, in Navadvīpa.

9 The residents of Kulīnagrāma and all the residents of Khaṇḍa came to Navadvīpa, and all met there together.

10 Although Nityānanda Prabhu did not have the Lord's permission, He still set out to see Caitanya Gosāñi.

11 Śrīvāsa and his brothers, four in all, went with Mālinī, and Ācāryaratna's wife went with him.

12 Śivānanda's wife went, taking her three sons, and Rāghava Paṇḍita went with his bags (*jhāli*) packed.

13 Vāsudeva Datta, Murāri Gupta, Vidyānidhi and all the others — two or three hundred devotees set out.

14 They all went to see Śacīmātā and, taking her permission, set out joyfully, chanting the names of Kṛṣṇa.

15 Śivānanda Sena settled matters at the toll posts (*ghāṭī*); taking care of everyone, he led them happily along.

16 He attended to all their affairs and found them places to stay, for Śivānanda knew the roads through Orissa well.

17 One day all the people were detained at a toll post. To get them all released, Śivānanda stayed behind alone.

18 The others went on and waited under a tree in a village, for without Śivānanda no lodging could be found.

19 Nityānanda Prabhu, distressed by hunger and finding no lodging, began to abuse Śivānanda:[1]

20 “May Śivānanda’s three sons die! He has still not come. I am dying of hunger, and he has not arranged any lodging for Me!”

21 Hearing this, Śivānanda’s wife began to weep. Just then Śivānanda came back from the toll post.

22 Weeping, Śivānanda’s wife said to him, “Finding no lodging, Gosāñi has laid a curse on our sons.”

23 He said, “Crazy woman, why are you killing yourself with weeping? Let my three sons die, taking His misfortunes upon themselves!”[2]

24 Saying this, Śivānanda went to the Lord. Nityānanda Prabhu rose and kicked him.

25 Receiving the blow of His foot, Śivānanda was delighted. He quickly went to the house of a cowherd (*goyālā*) and arranged lodging there.

26 Holding the Lord’s feet, he took Him to the lodging. Having given Him a place to stay, he spoke in delight:

27 “Today You have accepted me as Your servant. You have given the fruit that the servant’s offense deserved.

28 In the guise of punishment You show mercy — such is Your compassion. Who in the three worlds can understand Your character?

29 The dust of Your holy feet is rare even for Brahmā, yet my lowly body has received the touch of such feet.

30 Today my birth, my family and my deeds have become successful. Today I have obtained devotion to Kṛṣṇa, as well as wealth, pleasure and *dharma*.”

31 Hearing this, Nityānanda Prabhu was delighted at heart. He rose and embraced Śivānanda with love.

32 Delighted, Śivānanda made the arrangements and gave lodgings to Advaita Ācārya and the other Vaiṣṇavas.

33 All of Nityānanda Prabhu’s ways are paradoxical: when He becomes angry and kicks someone, He does that person good.[3]

34 Śivānanda had a nephew named Śrīkānta Sena. Hurt and indignant, he spoke when his uncle was out of hearing:

35 “My uncle is known as an associate of Caitanya, yet Gosāñi lords it over him and kicks him.”

36 Saying this, the boy Śrīkānta went on ahead. Leaving the party, he went in advance to where Mahāprabhu was.

37 Still wearing his shirt (*peṭāṅgi*), he offered prostrate obeisances. Govinda said, “Śrīkānta, first take off your shirt.”

38 The Lord said, “Śrīkānta has come here with a sorrowful heart. Say nothing to him; let him do as he pleases.”

39 The Lord asked for news of the Vaiṣṇavas, and Śrīkānta told Him about each of them by name.

40 Hearing the Lord say, “He has come here sorrowful,” Śrīkānta concluded that the Lord is omniscient.

41 He did not tell the Lord that Nityānanda had kicked Śivānanda. Meanwhile all the Vaiṣṇavas arrived and met the Lord.

42 As before, the Lord met with everyone, and the women had His *darśana* from a distance.

43 As before, He had lodgings given to everyone, and He called them all to take *mahā-prasāda*.

44 Śivānanda introduced his three sons to the Lord, and for Śivānanda's sake the Lord showed great mercy to them all.

45 Seeing the youngest son, the Lord asked his name, and Śivānanda Sena told Him it was Paramānanda dāsa.

46–47 Earlier, when Śivānanda had come to the Lord, Mahāprabhu had said to him, "The son who will be born to you this time — name him Purīdāsa."

48 That son was then in his mother's womb. Śivānanda went home, and the child was born.

49 By the Lord's order they named him Paramānanda dāsa, and the Lord jokingly called him Purīdāsa.

50 When Śivānanda presented that child, Mahāprabhu placed His big toe in the boy's mouth.

51 Who can reach the shore of the ocean of Śivānanda's good fortune? The Lord calls his whole family His own.

52 Then the Lord took His meal with all the devotees. After rinsing His mouth and hands, He gave Govinda an order:

53 “As long as Śivānanda’s wife and sons are here, they should receive the plate of My remnants.”

54 There was a confectioner (*modaka*), a resident of Nadīyā, named Parameśvara. He sold sweets, and his home was near the Lord’s house.

55 In His childhood the Lord would go to his house again and again, and Parameśvara would give Him milk, sugar and sweets, which He ate.

56 He had had affection for the Lord since the Lord’s childhood. That year he came to see the Lord.

57 Saying, “I am Parameśvarā,” he offered prostrate obeisances. Seeing him, the Lord spoke to him with affection:[4]

58 “Parameśvara, may you be well! It is good that you have come.” Then he told the Lord, “Mukunda’s mother has come.”

59 Hearing the name of Mukunda’s mother, the Lord felt embarrassed, yet out of affection for him He said nothing.[5]

60 The boldness of loving familiarity (*praśraya-prāgalbhya*) knows nothing of pure courtesy (*śuddha-vaidagdhī*). Within His heart the Lord was pleased with that quality of his.[6]

61 As before, the Lord cleansed the Guṇḍicā temple with everyone, and as before He danced in front of the chariot.

62 During the four months of *Cāturmāsya* they saw all the festivals, and Mālinī and the other ladies invited the Lord for meals.

63 They had brought from home various foodstuffs dear to the Lord. Making vegetable dishes with them, they offered Him meals of home-cooked rice.

64 By day the Lord enjoyed various pastimes with the devotees; at night He wept in separation from Kṛṣṇa.

65 In this way the four months of *Cāturmāsya* passed in various pastimes. Then the Lord ordered the devotees to return to the land of Gauḍa.

66 All the devotees invited Mahāprabhu for meals, and the Lord spoke sweet words to all of them:

67 "Every year you all come to see Me, and in coming and going you suffer hardships of many kinds.

68 Knowing your hardships, I want to forbid you to come. But in My heart the greed for the happiness of your company grows.

69 I ordered Nityānanda to remain in Gauḍa, yet He has broken My order and come. What can I say?

70 Ācārya Gosāñi has come here, showing Me mercy. I am bound by a debt of love that I can never repay.

71 For My sake they leave wife, sons and home, and come running over many difficult roads.

72 And I simply stay here, sitting in Nīlācala; I take no trouble for any of you.

73 I am a *sannyāsī*; I have no wealth at all. With what shall I repay My debt to you?

74 My body is My only wealth, and I have offered it to you. Wherever you wish to sell Me, there I am sold."

75 All were pleased at heart by the Lord's words, and all wept with tears streaming from their eyes.

76 Holding each of them by the neck, the Lord wept, and weeping and weeping He embraced them all.

77 Everyone stayed on; no one could leave. Five or seven more days passed in this way.

78 Then Advaita and the Avadhūta (Nityānanda) said something at the Lord's feet: "The whole world is naturally sold to Your qualities.

79 And now You bind us again with such a rope of merciful words! Who, leaving You, could go anywhere?"

80 Then the Lord consoled them all and, composing Himself, bade everyone farewell.

81 To Nityānanda He said, "Do not come again and again. There itself You will have My company."

82 All the devotees set off weeping, and Mahāprabhu remained at home, sorrowful.

83 By the quality of His own mercy the Lord bound everyone. Who can repay the debt of Mahāprabhu's mercy?

84 The Lord, the independent Supreme Lord, makes each one dance as He wills; therefore people leave Him and go to other lands.

85 As a conjurer makes a wooden puppet dance, so the Lord acts; His conduct cannot be understood at all.

86 The previous year Jagadānanda, taking the Lord's order, had gone to the town of Nadīyā to see Āi (mother Śacī).

87 Going to Āi, he worshipped her feet and presented her with cloth and *prasāda* of Jagannātha.

88 In the Lord's name he offered obeisance to the mother, and he conveyed to her the Lord's humble words of praise.

89 Having Jagadānanda with her, the mother was joyful at heart. He spoke of the Lord, and she listened night and day.

90 Jagadānanda said, "Mother, on certain days the Lord comes here to you and eats.

91 After eating, He says joyfully, 'Today Mother fed Me till I was full to the throat.

92 I go there and eat, and Mother does not know it. I eat in person, but she takes it for a dream.'"

93 The mother said, "How many excellent dishes I cook! 'May Nimāi eat them here'—such is the desire of my heart.

94 It seems to me that Nimāi has eaten, but afterwards I think: 'I saw a dream.'"

95 In this way Jagadānanda spoke with mother Śacī, night and day, of happy things about Caitanya.

96 He met all the devotees of Nadīyā, and they all rejoiced to have Jagadānanda with them.

97 Then Jagadānanda went to meet the Ācārya (Advaita), and the Ācārya was overjoyed to see him.

98 Vāsudeva and Murāri Gupta, having Jagadānanda with them, joyfully kept him in their homes and would not let him go.

99 From his mouth they heard intimate talks about Caitanya, and in the joy of those talks all of them forgot themselves.

100 Whichever devotee's house Jagadānanda went to, that devotee forgot himself in joy.

101 Blessed is Jagadānanda, the object of Caitanya's love! Whoever met him felt, "I have found Caitanya."

102 He went and stayed in Śivānanda Sena's house, and there he prepared one *mātrā* (sixteen *sers*) of *candanādi* oil.

103 He made the oil fragrant, filled a *gāgarī* (a large pitcher) with it, and carefully brought it to Nīlācala.

104 He left the oil with Govinda and told him, "Apply this oil to the Lord's body."

105 Then Govinda submitted to the Lord: "Jagadānanda has brought *candanādi* oil.

106 His wish is that You apply a little to Your head, so that the aggravation of the disorders of bile and air (*pitta* and *vāyu*) may subside.

107 He prepared a pitcher of fragrant oil in Gauḍa and brought it here with great care.”

108 The Lord said, “A *sannyāsī* has no right to oil—and fragrant oil at that is an utter disgrace!

109 Give the oil to Jagannātha, so that it may burn in the lamps; then his labour will bear the highest fruit.”

110 Govinda told Jagadānanda this message. The Paṇḍita remained silent and said nothing.

111 When ten days had passed, Govinda informed the Lord once more: “The Paṇḍita wishes that You accept the oil.”

112 Hearing this, the Lord spoke some angry words: “Then keep a masseur to give Me massages!

113 Was it for this pleasure that I took *sannyāsa*? For Me it would be utter ruin, and for all of you a joke!

114 Whoever passes Me on the road and catches the scent of oil on Me will call Me a *dārī-sannyāsī* (a *sannyāsī* who keeps women).”

115 Hearing the Lord’s words, Govinda fell silent. In the morning Jagadānanda came to the Lord.

116 The Lord said, “Paṇḍita, you have brought oil from Gauḍa, but I am a *sannyāsī* and cannot accept oil.

117 Take it and give it to Jagannātha, so that it may burn in the lamps; then all your labour will bear fruit.”

118 The Paṇḍita said, “Who tells You these lies? I never brought any oil from Gauḍa.”

119 So saying, he brought the pitcher of oil out of the room and smashed it in the courtyard before the Lord.

120 Having broken the oil pitcher, he went straight to his own house, bolted the door and lay down inside.

121 On the third day the Lord went to his door and called out, “Get up, Paṇḍita!

122 Today you will cook and give Me My *bhikṣā* (meal). I shall come at midday; now I am going for *darśana* (of Jagannātha).”

123 So saying, the Lord left, and the Paṇḍita got up, bathed and cooked various dishes.

124 Having finished His midday duties, the Lord came to eat. He washed His feet and sat down on His seat.

125 On a banana leaf the Paṇḍita heaped fine *śāli* rice with ghee, and all around it he set banana-leaf cups filled with dishes.

126 On the rice and the dishes lay *tulasī* blossoms, and he brought Jagannātha’s cakes and sweet drinks and set them before the Lord.

127 The Lord said, “Serve rice and dishes on a second leaf. Today you and I shall eat together.”

128 The Lord sat with His hand raised and did not eat. Then the Paṇḍita spoke some loving words:

129 “You take the *prasāda* first; I shall take it afterwards. How could I disregard Your insistence?”

130 Then Mahāprabhu happily sat down to eat. Tasting the dishes, He began to speak:

131 “Cooking done in a fit of anger has such a taste! From this I know that Kṛṣṇa’s grace is upon you.

132 Because Kṛṣṇa Himself will eat it, He has the cooking done so excellently by your hands.

133 You offer such nectarean food to Kṛṣṇa—who can describe the limit of your good fortune?”

134 The Paṇḍita said, “The One who will eat is Himself the cook. People like me are merely collectors of the ingredients.”

135 Again and again the Paṇḍita served various dishes. Out of fear the Lord said nothing and ate with delight.

136 The Paṇḍita insisted and fed Him, and He ate ten times more than on other days.

137 Again and again the Lord made up His mind to rise, and at that very moment the Paṇḍita would serve more dishes.

138 The Lord could not say anything; He ate out of fear: “If I do not eat, Jagadānanda will fast.”

139 Then the Lord spoke with humble respect: “You have fed Me tenfold; now bring it to an end.”

140 Then Mahāprabhu rose and rinsed His mouth and hands (*ācamana*), and the Paṇḍita brought spices to freshen His mouth, a garland and sandalwood paste.

141 Accepting the sandalwood paste and the rest, the Lord sat down right there: “Today you must eat in front of Me.”

142 The Paṇḍita said, “Let the Lord go and rest. I shall take *prasāda* now, once I have finished arranging things.

143 Rāmāi and Raghunātha have done the work in the kitchen; I want to give all of them some rice and dishes.”

144 The Lord said, “Govinda, you stay right here. When the Paṇḍita has eaten, tell Me.”

145 So saying, Mahāprabhu departed, and the Paṇḍita said some words to Govinda:

146 “Go quickly and massage the Lord’s feet. Tell Him: ‘The Paṇḍita has now sat down to eat.’

147 I shall keep the Lord’s remnants (*śeṣa*) for you. When the Lord falls asleep, come and eat.”

148 To Rāmāi, Nandāi, Govinda and Raghunātha he gave shares of the Lord’s rice and dishes.

149 He himself ate the Lord’s remnants. Then the Lord sent Govinda again:

150 “See whether Jagadānanda is taking *prasāda* or not, and come quickly and tell Me the news.”

151 Govinda came, saw, and reported that the Paṇḍita was eating. Then Mahāprabhu lay down at ease.

152 In this way the love between Jagadānanda and the Lord goes on, as we hear in the *Bhāgavata* of the love between Satyabhāmā and Kṛṣṇa.

153 Who can tell the limit of Jagadānanda’s good fortune? Of Jagadānanda’s good fortune he alone is the comparison.

154 Whoever hears Jagadānanda’s *Prema-vivarta* knows the true nature of love and attains the wealth of love.[7]

155 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.

Notes

1. The *Anubhāṣya* heads this verse: Nityānanda, in His transcendental form as a cowherd boy of Vraja, has not satisfied His hunger and shows Śivānanda a feigned semblance of anger. ↩
2. *Tāṅra bālāi laña*, “taking His misfortunes upon themselves”: an expression of loving devotion, wishing that every ill that threatens the beloved may fall upon oneself. ↩
3. The *Anubhāṣya* heads this verse: the semblance of anger in Nityānanda, the *guru*, is a hidden, supreme mercy and the sign of eternal good. ↩
4. *Parameśvarā* (*parameśvaryā*): the homely form in which the simple confectioner speaks his own name. ↩
5. The *Anubhāṣya*: the Lord, the *guru* of the world and teacher of people, who enacted the pastime of *sannyāsa*, felt embarrassed on hearing a woman’s name, even though she was elderly and like a mother to Him. ↩

6. To say to a *sannyāsī*, “Mukunda’s mother has come,” is the boldness born of long familiarity (*Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*). The *Anubhāṣya* records the variant reading *praśraya-pāgala*, “simple in his affection,” and explains: *praśraya* — affection, affectionate respect, humility, trust, loving liberty; *prāgalbhya* — boldness, forwardness; *vaidagdhī* — refinement, polish, skill, elegance of manners. The Lord, who accepts the feeling of the heart, was pleased with his guilelessness. ↩
7. *Prema-vivarta*: the *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya* gives two meanings — the *vivarta* of love, that is, the behaviour in which, in the dealings of love, anger seems to appear; and the book *Prema-vivarta*, in which Jagadānanda wrote about Mahāprabhu’s life. ↩